

Unprofitable Authenticity

Dad's Letters

Doors That Look Like Disruptions

I am not writing this because I think something is wrong with you. Quite the opposite. I am writing this because much of life can go on for a long time without seeming broken at all. That is part of the problem. We learn to function, to pursue, to adapt, to recover, and to continue. We become competent inside structures that seem natural simply because they are familiar and rewarded.

But life has a way of opening doors that look like disruptions, though they are gifts. Sometimes they arrive through hardship, confusion, loss, or exhaustion. Sometimes they arrive through success, when everything that was supposed to be enough turns out not to be enough. In either case, the common temptation is to fix the disruption and get back to normal as quickly as possible.

I have done that myself many times. It is painful. Worse, it wastes valuable openings.

The hardest part is that it may not occur to you that the real problem is not only the event itself, but the structure of thought you bring to it. I "solved" and "fixed" more than one opening in my life as though it were an interruption. I repaired the frame and stepped back inside it. It took me a long time to realize that I was not merely missing opportunities. I was using a way of thinking that made it almost impossible to recognize them for what they were.

From very early in life, we are taught to move along a line. Kindergarten prepares you for school. School prepares you for college. College prepares you for work. Work prepares you for advancement. One accomplishment is supposed to lead to the next. This way of living is so common that it feels identical with life itself.

It is useful. That is why it is hard to question.

The same structure can be described in three ways. It is how society organizes you. It is how others can control you. And it is how you learn to control yourself: set the aim, build the path, improve yourself, continue forward. All three are built on the same assumption — that life is best understood as a line of purposeful movement toward the next correct thing.

My concern is not that this structure is always false. It is simply too small. A line is useful, but a life is not a line.

This becomes most visible at certain turns in life. As long as you are moving through a corridor, aiming for the other end, the structure serves you well enough. But sooner or later life places you somewhere wider. Sometimes you hit a wall. Sometimes you emerge from a tunnel. Sometimes a door opens gently; sometimes you are pushed through it. What matters is that at such moments the old structure is no longer enough.

That happened to me more than once. Some of those moments were quiet. Some were abrupt. Looking back, I believe they were not punishments but openings into a simpler, wider, more honest life. I missed many of them. They did not fit anything I knew how to think. All I saw was a hole in a well-built wall. So I patched the wall and adjusted my run.

It took me far too long to suspect that the events were not the problem. My thinking was.

This is why I am writing these letters. I would like you to be less unprepared than I was. I would like you to know, before life forces the issue, that there are ways of thinking that do not reduce everything to a line, a role, a score, or a narrative. Those ways are not mystical. They are natural, practical, and available. They can help you see more clearly what is happening, why it matters, and what is worth doing when the old structures stop being enough.

This is not wishful thinking. I have learned it, and I live it. I can lay out the details. But it can only be done deliberately. I can show it. Whether you take it up is entirely up to you.

If someone had told me earlier that not every disruption is a problem, that some turns in life are doors out, and that one can learn to think in a way that sees them, I would have wasted less and suffered less.

That is what I want to give you now.

Letter 1: Cognitive Freedom

Part I: The Invisible Cage

Our brain is strange: we focus to the exclusion of everything else, yet our view of the world feels complete, with no holes. How does it happen?

Claude: Human focus operates like a spotlight, amplifying certain information while suppressing other signals. The brain actively filters and prioritizes what reaches conscious awareness. Your brain creates what feels like a seamless experience even though it's actually constructing this reality from limited, filtered information.

Alex: It was probably meant for short periods of time, but it can last for years, creating a virtual reality bubble.

I would like to dive into what it feels like but let's clarify terms. I use the word thinking to mean an intentional activity carried out for a purpose. This is in contrast to *noise in the head* that we often take seriously because it is "our thoughts".

Claude: Your observation noise resonates strongly with research on the default mode network. The brain's default activity feels like "thoughts" but is actually just neural noise. Studies show most mental activity is indeed automatic pattern-matching rather than deliberate reasoning.

Alex: Let's talk about *narrative thinking* as a particular kind. I define *narrative thinking* as thinking along conversational paths, embedded in the common phrases "create a narrative" or "control a narrative."

When people think narratively, they move back and forth between reasons and results along a tree of close relations. Ordinarily, they step back one layer and produce a 'here is why.' Deeper thinkers may go back two. If that backward walk is smooth, the reasoning feels justified. People validate the cause-result relations by checking the tree structure, not by how well it describes something real out in the world. Good syntax check becomes the proof, no validity check required.

Silent Objectives

A modern person's mind is filled with a large number of such trees. Few of them are intentionally installed. Most are installed by parents, school, friends, and random people we interact throughout life.

Each tree was built for a purpose. Oddly, that purpose is almost never discussed.

Parents instill trees often for their own convenience, partly for a clear purpose, partly copying what is in their heads, which may range from thoughtful, to idiotic, to criminal. Teachers have all kinds of objectives besides or often above the comprehension of a subject: their own well-being, earning a salary, avoiding troubles, etc. Professional training is purposeful too: not so much to make you good at the profession, as to make you in good service to a profession.

The education system implies that these trees are objective and represent collective deep knowledge. One may feel that these trees are rooted in some hard truth. But they are not. They are products of incoherent objectives, and, therefore, they cannot connect. And they don't.

As a result, tree-based mind is fragmented. The way we are trained to focus our attention makes this fragmentation hard to spot.

The Attention Trap

We use our attention as a spotlight, focusing narrowly on one fragment tree at a time. Then we switch to another. In that narrow focus we bypass all inconsistencies and maintain implied faith in standing on solid ground.

This narrow, spotlight-style attention makes narrative thinking look effective, sufficient, and correct.

It lights up one "hot" tree, which drives the *narrative thinking* of the moment. The world looks coherent, whole and complete.

This lasts until some event causes an attention mechanism to switch and spotlight a different tree.

The cause of the switch is often not conscious. We usually have no narrative for the switch itself. Instead, we habitually narrate as though our being remained continuous throughout. This switch replaces a running narrative that keeps flowing.

Focus moves from one tree fragment to another. What is included and excluded from perception switches accordingly. The very words, essential objects, specific meaning, and the very language is replaced. The "us" becomes a different person. It is obvious to bystanders, less obvious to colleagues with common professional narratives, and hidden from the actual person.

Narratives Construct Objectified Pictures

Nodes in a tree feel like objects out in the world because they function as markers within the narrative. They act like nouns in the language of the tree. It is easy to spot if we trace the same out-in-the-world object thru narrowing trees:

a sentient being -> human -> man -> defender -> soldier -> heroes and casualties

Each step is narrower and more purposeful, yet it still feels real within the context of the tree. A mental tree must have it as its defining element. A real object out in the world has no purpose or no singular purpose.

Professional Expertise is Often a Bubble too

In modern life, being linguistically correct within a specialized tree makes someone look professional. Professional education often copies a curriculum of trees and adds a surface layer of sophistication.

On examination, most professional trees are two-three layers deep and circumstantial with a rare exception of hard sciences.

Part II: The Warrior Virtual Headset

Narrative thinking has been institutionalized. None of us started with education in being human. Standard education trains us to become skilled, intelligent, compliant components - preprogrammed for easy integration without understanding the full context.

I call it a "warrior virtual headset."

If you want an obedient army, train people to handle a sword, be fit, understand tactics, command structure, etc., but you don't tell them how to live life on their own. You set the aim, split the loot, give your army a rest, and repeat. They live, understand, feel useful, compete - all within your frame.

Narrative structures are ideal control structures. They capture narrow skills, channel thinking along predictable lines, objectify the world without contradictions, replace thinking with a quick and easy syntax check, and making people comfortable within the structure.

A natural question is: does it matter? Would you want out? How and why?

I know a few people who are blissfully comfortable in it. Most people, though, run into what looks like rough edges due to life's natural twists.

These edges are gifts - doors out - but a narrative mind sees them as disruptions. It corrects the issues, adjusts life arrangement to feel comfortable again within the narrative structure.

So, why even consider anything else, any other way of thinking? Certainly not to be more successful since success is defined as a part of a narrative.

Here is Why.

For me, it is a question of human dignity. I believe we have that innate awareness that's not limited to a narrative. And a better use of human life is to know ourselves as we truly are. I believe that *narrative thinking* exploits our very awareness but conveniently omits it from a custom-made warrior headset.

There are more ways to arrive at why. My initial impulse was born differently: *narrative thinking* results in ... a narrative, a text, a long line that can be read or written, a line, a one-dimensional object. One-dimensional object cannot possibly cover the world because the world is not one dimensional. It is structural mismatch.

If we think one-dimensional thoughts, in a multi-dimensional world, what are we missing? A lot, for sure. Mind boggling. Can we think two-dimensionally, three-dimensionally, etc.?

That was my initial motivation. After finding such ways and experiencing them I started seeing it as a question of human dignity.

It is time for the How.

Part III: A Path to Cognitive Freedom

Geometry of Attention

A narrative is a text that can be written as a long line. It is one-dimensional and, by definition, cannot cover higher-dimensional structures. We live in a multi-dimensional world. Therefore, the question becomes: can I come up with two-dimensional thinking?

I discovered the following process. Stick large paper on the wall and write your thoughts as they come. Make it easy, have markers handy. Don't position or align. Just write. Add more paper as needed; in practice, three or four easel sheets will do.

It's important for the thoughts to be on a wall within your sight.

If you write in a computer, you will be narrating multiple times: to locate a file, to type into a file, to remember to look at it, to read back. The same with the notebook. And this is precisely what we want to avoid.

An edgeless paper and a marker is the least possible effort that results in a visually observable wall of thoughts. Moreover, it is within a single sight, hence no narrating is needed to piece it together. Colors are fine and stimulating, as long as they are random. Do not color-code your thoughts.

This process runs through several stages.

Stage 1: Discovery of Volume

First stage is the Discovery of the Volume. Contrary to the common myth that we have 100,000 thoughts a day, all my thoughts were on the wall within the first week. You literally feel an urge to add a thought but visually see that it is already there. It might be formulated slightly differently, but it is

there. And it is obvious to you, because you recognize it immediately. In about a week, I did not have a new thought to add.

All thoughts are out of my head, on a few flip-chart sheets, and in one sight! Shocking.

Each thought drains a little energy each time it has to be recreated in attention. No longer paying that toll over and over just to keep thoughts alive is a great relief.

The main discovery was that my thoughts can be seen as a whole.

Stage 2: Slow Trickle

Stage two is a slow trickle of new thoughts. A week passes with no new thoughts, sometimes one. All thoughts are within your sight. You get comfortable observing them as a whole.

The discovery of stage two is that the volume stays stable and observable.

Stage 3: The Power of Sight

The third stage is simply letting them sit within your sight. Enjoy the show. Still observable. The trick though is to let it fall within your sight often. Hopefully the wall is in your office and you often see it naturally. And there is where magic starts happening. The very sight itself, turns out, has a power to transform it and ultimately comprehend it. No narrative. All you do is... your sight recognizes it and surprises you along the way.

A new critical working element emerges. It is a **geometry of your attention**.

Consider your head as having a size. Think of a beam of light from your head (your eyes) as it falls on to an element on the wall. Normally, attention narrows down like a cone with a sharp edge going towards an active object, an active tree—whatever you pay attention to. It highlights and lights up one tree at a time. We call it focus.

But when we look at the picture on the wall, attention goes from the head extending out, to light up the wall. The cone is inverted. It does not narrow down; it widens. Turns out, it is a different kind of attention. Narrowing down attention focuses on a single thing to exclude the rest or to trace relations between two objects of focus. Widening attention gains an aperture. It focuses on stuff—the mess so far—that is embedded in the whole but it does not stop seeing each individual element.

In particular, wide angle covers more than one tree even while your thinking is still tree-bound. You start noticing switching. You start asking why am I being switched. Did I mean to switch or what has just happened that I switched.

The third stage discovery is two fold. You realize you see or don't see based on the geometry of your attention. It is OK that it is random so far. The moments of widening angle bring about stage four.

The moments of not having widening angle bring a sense that you are losing something like going blind. It comes with a desire to have some degree of control.

Stage 4: Self-Organization

The fourth stage is looking at the mess on the wall and seeing it changing its shape. You naturally start organizing it because why not? The attention itself shaped as a wider view has a sense of a scene. It comes with power to organize on its own logic.

An example of new logic is the famous statement "a rifle on a wall fires in the second act." This does not need details of who, why, when. Nature will supply the details as life unfolds. A rifle on a wall fulfills its role in the second act. No sooner, no later. If you want more shooting—add a second rifle. No shooting—remove the rifle. We can see it. No narrative is needed.

It starts simple: some pieces naturally fall into nice to-do lists. Then some to-do lists are done and gone. Perhaps because they are ripe. Some are gone because they are isolated. For example, I realized that my wall contained a few designs ideas that I wanted to do my whole life but never had a practical reason to complete. And so, I just completed them. They are done, and out of my system. The picture on the wall becomes simpler. So far, we are not out of narratives—but we are getting rid of accidental ones.

Week three or four, thoughts morph into a really neat and compact picture. It looks perfect. Much fewer elements, all aligned and clear. This is even more relaxing. Most people stop here and it doesn't help them much other than neatness go. My advice is to keep it in sight till it transforms further on its own. You don't really need to do anything: leave it on a wall and your attention naturally sees it.

The stage four discovery is this: wide-angle sight causes the picture to evolve. Wide angle re-arranges toward clarity and simplicity. Narrowing the angle of sight stops this process.

Stage 5: The Magic Begins

The fifth stage came out of the blue: what is this man actually thinking about, such that these specific thoughts appear? This was my first shock.

Imagine you see a part of the wall covered in steering wheel sketches and this or that engine ideas. Looking at them, I realized that the guy is thinking about a car. The rest of the car feels obvious, and that's why he's not thinking about the rest of it. But there is no way to create a car out of a wheel and an engine. All of a sudden, the very triviality of the rest of the car is creative because he is thinking of a particular car. Then the engine is not arbitrary, it's specific. And the steering wheel is not arbitrary either. All of a sudden, you can finish all of it: the engine, the wheel, and the whole car, in one stroke, because you're ready. The car was out of your sight; it never fell into a spotlight of your attention. You

might have started to believe you like engines, perhaps it should be your profession. Nope, the whole thing simpler and concrete. And you can finish it in a few strokes.

Thoughts start disappearing from the wall without being suppressed. They find their places in a larger context. It makes them meaningful, completed, and released.

Four or five weeks into the process, only seven thoughts remain on the wall. I am familiar with them. They keep coming in different forms and details in multiple disjointed fragments. They are not reducible; they do not resolve. I see them threading through my life over and over.

The discovery of the fifth stage is that I have a handful of thoughts all along. That's it.

Please note, we arrive at a place that is not reachable with *narrative thinking*. We are in a new world; we landed on Mars. And we have a new propulsion engine: it is the geometry of our attention. It becomes like a muscle memory, a physical sensation, almost like a hand.

Stage 6: The Core Discovery

I admired the simplicity of seven thoughts for a while. Seven is easy to remember. It doesn't take much space. I cannot add or remove anything. Luckily, I didn't take them off the wall.

Suddenly, I saw what they meant.

It may sound a little pathetic—but all seven really meant how love in a limited world looked from seven perspectives. It was as if I wrote seven concrete ways it manifests so that I don't lose it. It turned out to be one thought all along, appearing in seven forms. It is not a thought to keep turning around in your mind; not what we commonly call “love”; not some universal truth. But when something arose that I did not know how to place, I could ask: ‘Does this carry the meaning of how love manifests in a limited world? And the meaning would come clear. All along, this was the thought. And I barely met it before.

I would know that I don't really care to be the best designer but the technical perfection was a particular manifestation within a context of something bigger. I can now drive my life with clarity.

This also brought another tool into my toolbox: backward planning.

I started to use backward planning a lot: coming with the end and figuring out the intermediate steps that lead to it. There are lots of details to this technique which I skip. Military uses it a lot, and it's a very developed, multilayered process. But for me it did not make practical sense until I got to seven thoughts on the wall and, then, to one. I could not create a stable target of where I want to end up. Hopeful thinking does not create an authentic target; it only remains valid within the narrative you have temporarily preferred.

Attention as an Embodied Sensation

I understood that manipulating attention is a trainable skill. It results in totally different pictures, almost different realities. If you allow the cone of light to flip into a narrow headlight focused on a mental tree, you fall into a bubble, and you don't know it. But if you keep wide attention, then, at least, it shows you you're falling into a bubble. It is helpful right there. It also allows you to see a wider picture of who you are, what you're doing, and why. You can perceive and control your path from a human perspective.

I started tracking my attention. I came to feel that attention is closer to what I am than the sum total of my knowledge and activity. All of those became a content in the attention.

Knowing as Embodied Sensation

As I got used to the attention itself as a proper body sensation, the other things clicked and connect. It becomes practical that I simply know what is the right thing to do. I know the answer. I can narrate it if I need to, but it is as convincing as a rifle on the wall. I don't need a narrative as "a proof."

I started to trust the feeling of being rooted in the non-contrived attention as a quality, as a sign of good health. This feeling is not an emotion. It's more like a hand gripping an object and feeling its texture.

This became a tool number two.

I had more insights that turned into tools. It is harder to describe as less common language is available. As these tools accumulated and proved their worth, a new question arose:

Can one *not* fall back into a narrative thinking as a default?

The Solution: Transparent Contour

The question is practical since you were training for 10-20-40 years to encapsulate in a bubble comfortably. You have a habit of doing so. You got "A"-s on numerous tests of successful bubble inhabitation. It is comfortable because it comes with all fixtures installed to the point you don't even know it is a bubble. With this extensive training you must be falling into *narrative thinking* habitually.

How not to?

The solution I found is to remind myself that I have to create intentionally a transparent contour within a narrated context I want to engage with. On one hand it serves the interaction with the world and people in a particular situation. On the other hand, it's a transparent contour; it does not have perception on its own, it passes through all perception, feeling, sensing to the awareness behind it. You don't become it. You are the awareness of it within a wider scope. It does not cost extra because you are always aware; you cannot stop that entirely. Even to be suppressed, a specific perception has

to be perceived first. So, awareness is always on, but it is not directly accessible from within a bubble. Here is a simple "engine check": if you— as a transparent contour—are ready to fail then you are good. If you have to survive—you encapsulated already. Perhaps you need to an edgeless paper on a wall. You have to engage one of the non narrative tools you have while you still remember that there are alternatives.

With a transparent contour-shell, a small "i", you have a local perception, a conditioned understanding within a local context, but you also maintain a wider context and wider awareness. You don't have to switch constantly between wide view and narrow view, which is tricky, costly, and exhausting.

I don't necessarily have to keep track of that transparent contour "i" as a separate activity. I just need to turn it on in the same way as I need a wrench when I deal with a bolt and a nut.

Any conversation is a narrative by definition; it can localize you in itself, unless you also see yourself as an "i" talking to specific people. Essentially, a simple conversation is the most obvious and most frequent way to lose a wider awareness.

Level 4 is a transparent contour of a small "i" as an acknowledged stream within a wider awareness.

How do you know it is working?

Extraordinary statement needs extraordinary proof. This different way of thinking is more efficient because it leads to solutions that were not available through *narrative thinking*. Moreover, while narrative thinking is *scripting* you, these new solutions are out of the *script*.

This is why I highlighted those unexpected aha moments above: the realization that I have only seven thoughts, or even one, and the lightness that comes with that clarity, ability to control the kind of thinking through the shape of attention, events unfolding as written even if forgotten, realization that attention and awareness can be innately perceived or felt just as "legs" and "eyes", the sense that world of events is a content of awareness rather than me being an outside observer of the world.

I made a bunch of changes in my everyday life that altered its quality. Each change did not work as a local improvement but the whole worked. I never saw any practical path before.

Other proofs come as gifts. Here is one example:

I like walking without being busy. As I walk, a gift I call "zip files" would appear. It feels like a dense ball that start unfolding into several book chapters with examples and illustrations. It will answer a long-standing question with thorough details and examples I did not know to ask for. I could test it immediately in the world and confirm that it is, in fact, working.

All of the above serve to build a trust.

Can It Be Taught?

I tried to pass on the wall technique when I saw a friend struggling with clarity.

Most people don't complete a first attempt because they start *improving* the technique. I would hear "I prefer to write in my notebook" or "I wrote on pieces of paper and saved them". Of course, it puts it out of sight, and nothing happens.

A few people completed it. I heard of an unexpected clarity that lasted for months. I heard "yes, I have eight thoughts." Sometimes, it takes a few months to "wait, why is it on my mind".

It's probably 10% who can extract something from it. It works for people who have a problem to solve.

The first time, the wall technique takes a few months. This is very fast relative to 10-20 years of ordinary education. And it does not compromise the education. It makes its use purposeful and deliberate.

Letter 2: Unprofitable Authenticity

In modern life, you extract your livelihood from social systems. This makes you a party to social games where individual players face systematic resourceful opponents. Yet you don't want to be manipulated to the point of becoming scripted.

Manipulating "Success"

The asymmetry comes from a fundamental deception: society tells you that being more "successful" is the essential game. But this is precisely what makes you manipulatable—because society controls the narrative that defines success and how to measure it.

From a human perspective, consider someone who awakens "0 days old" coming to life with fresh eyes. Progressing from this start to a normal western daily routine, one can realize a simple truth: what life actually is remains either unknowable or intentionally hidden. Hence, it's conceivable that the value of societal success is actually zero relative to a fresh authentic perspective.

Human Self-Definition

We can make this question of costs and manipulated success definitions even sharper if we assume that humans differ from rocks in their ability to create their own definition of what success means. We definitely know this from historical examples—when human beings were able to do exactly this. A very small minority, but we remember their names and teach about them in schools.

If we accept that self-definition is one of the unique features of being human, then being preprogrammed and given predetermined purposes, scores, success metrics, and means to achieve them represents the opposite of what it means to be human.

Hijacking Emotional Architecture

Social games run at the top-level narratives. The emotions, feelings, and raw human responses are treated as plugged into these narratives. The terms that these narratives are made of are narratives themselves. We already saw an example of layered narration:

a sentient being -> human -> man -> defender -> soldier -> heroes and casualties

Notice, that each step allows simpler substitutions keeping the narratives flowing. Hence, the entire “human experience” runs through the top-level narratives while the game board can be adjusted as needed.

Effective Anti-Hijacking Strategies

What a small agent can do not to gain an upper hand but to maintain enough autonomy to exercise self-determination?

You partially withhold information in order to create a double bind: the system sees compliance, while you experience autonomy.

The sweet spot is being **unprofitably authentic**—too boring to warrant serious manipulation resources, but internally free enough to pursue genuine self-definition in the margins.

This isn't just a defensive tactic—it might be the only way to exist as a genuinely self-determining being within a system designed to limit self-determination.

Systems as Natural Phenomena

I have a side comment that does not need a response. But let's have it for completeness. System is not necessarily evil. System is created for a purpose. It's efficient for that purpose, and every system protects itself; it survives. It also manipulates you for its purpose because it lives on you. By the very fact that humans are natively combinable into systems—systems will exist. It is not necessarily an evil system built to play against you. It's a natural condition.

It is also possible for a system to exist without naming itself, without claiming authorship of any narrative. It may inject pieces into societal narratives. As a result, they are not consciously acknowledged. You may be in it without knowing it because the narrator voice is in your head. Incomplete narratives will appear as thoughts and you can take them to think through. Of course, there are societies and systems that become self-serving but systems in general occur naturally.

The Ultimate Defense: Return to Pure Awareness

Unprofitable authenticity as a defense works only to the point that the privileged adversary does not see through that. Eventually, it will; some subtle signal that gives your position away.

The only ultimate mechanism of defense is to ignore all this multilayered structure. Learn to live without. Prepare while not discovered.

This goes all the way to the contemplative tradition: understanding and operating your attention or consciousness as a layer before naming occurs.

Learning to do that, to the point where you trust what lies prior to narrative, is the main preparation. Luckily, it does not take 20 years of schooling, it is available just not used.

That is the role of *Unprofitable Authenticity*.

Letter 3: The Moment of Departure

It is important to recognize the nature of this moment. A 'live happily ever after' may feel like the natural next chapter, but that would be wrong.

It is a Moment of Departure.

Narrative thinking is the machinery that scripts humans. Hence the advice not to use it carelessly as a default. Since we all start trained in *narrative thinking*, it is worth getting out of it.

As a scientist, I approached it from the perspective that anything better should prove its efficiency before the transition. I developed a set of tools that are more effective within the narrative thinking environment and can also get you out of it, complete with a way to interact with narratives without being sucked in.

You can *test drive* these tools in real life, gain trust and understanding before being ready to trust them with your life. That was critical for me.

The role of a dad is to see you through from birth to full human autonomy. When you are out of college and living successfully within the common script, you are not there yet. You are merely successfully scripted, while your human nature rides in the background. A fully autonomous human being is self-determining.

How does it feel on the outside? Let's take these letters as an example. My fingers typed it, my brain edited, and my eyes saw it coming together. But I can assure you I didn't plan for it, didn't allocate time, did not inspire toward it. It just happened. It is a small miracle for me. This is how it feels.

There is no bright line to tell you it is safe; you can switch now. The answer arises naturally. As you test-drive non-narrative thinking, exit doors open up. They were always there but narratives carried you past them.

Your non-narrative experience accumulates. You tested new tools in difficult circumstances, you started operating at a level you did not expect, you may be praised for being insightful and efficient *within the narratives*. One day, you saw enough and you are out.

This is what I did for myself. I offer you these tools.

When you are out, the story ends. Will there be a letter four? I have no idea.

Love you, Dad.